

There are usually more options than people are told.

When money gets tight or a property becomes a burden, most people believe they have two choices: keep struggling, or sell. In reality, there are several paths in between. Here are the ones worth knowing about.

Every situation is different, and not all of these will fit yours. The point of this guide is simply to show you that the choices are wider than they first appear, so you can make a calm, informed decision instead of a rushed one.

Some of these need a mortgage professional, a lawyer, or an accountant to set up properly. Part of what I do is help you see which options are worth exploring, then point you to the right person to carry each one out. **Your decision, on your timing.**

1 Lower what the home costs you each month

If the monthly payment is the real pressure:

- **Restructure the mortgage**, a lower rate, a longer amortization, or rolling higher-interest debt in to reduce the total monthly.
- **Ask the lender about hardship options**, many offer temporary relief, deferrals, or a skipped payment when you're going through a rough patch.
- **Check your property tax**, your assessment may be appealable, and some municipalities offer deferrals for seniors or lower incomes.
- **Re-shop your insurance**, premiums often creep up quietly; a fresh quote can bring an easy saving.

2 Have the property earn its keep

If you have space that isn't being used:

- **Add a legal suite**, a basement, garden, or laneway unit where your lot and zoning allow it, for steady rental income.
- **Rent a room, the parking, or storage**, smaller steps that still bring in real monthly income.
- **Furnished mid-term rental**, renting to relocating professionals or travelling workers can out-earn a standard long lease.
- **Rent the home as a film or photo location**, a distinctive property can earn a meaningful day rate.

3 Access your equity without a full sale

If the value is in the home but you need cash or breathing room:

- **A reverse mortgage**, for homeowners 55+, a way to draw on equity and stay in the home, often with no monthly payment.
- **Sever and sell surplus land**, if you have a large lot, part of it may be sellable while you keep the house.
- **Bring in a partner, or sell and lease back**, ways to share the load or free up cash while remaining in place.
- **Rent-to-own**, sell over time to a buyer who rents first, giving you income now and a sale later.

4 Raise the value before you refinance or sell

If a little work could change your numbers:

- **Legalize an existing basement apartment**, doing it properly can lift both the value and the financing.
- **Targeted, high-return improvements**, kitchen, bathroom, paint, and curb appeal, done where they pay back.
- **Clear the issues that scare lenders**, fixing deferred maintenance so an appraisal and financing go smoothly.
- **Build the value before you list**. If a sale is on the table, I help plan the improvements, positioning, and pricing strategy that pull out the most value, and I bring vetted trades so the work gets quoted honestly.

→ How I help you work through this

You don't have to sort out which of these fits on your own:

- **We start before any "for sale" sign**. First we look for the moves that quietly strengthen your position, lowering the carrying cost, adding income where the property allows, and only the upgrades that return more than they cost.
- **A decade across complex Ontario files**. Power of sale, mortgage arrears, estate work, time-sensitive sales. I know where these get stuck, and I've sat across from everyone they bring: lenders, lawyers, opposing parties, family members.
- **The right professional for each step**. Where an option needs a mortgage professional, a lawyer, or an accountant, I bring in the right one so it's set up properly, you're never left to coordinate it alone.
- **Qualified buyers of our own**. If a sale becomes the answer, alongside a full-market listing we can often bring pre-screened buyers directly, more than one path to a clean, timely close.
- **Calm, private, and on your terms**. Understand the situation, lay out the plan, protect your equity and your privacy, from the first conversation to the closing table.

- **Cash-ready buyers, on standby**

If a sale turns out to be the right move, you are not limited to a sign on the lawn and a wait. Alongside a full-market listing, I work with **cash-ready buyers who can purchase as-is and close in weeks**, privately, with no showings and no public listing if you prefer.

What that means for you: more than one way out, a timeline you control, and a real fallback if certainty matters more than squeezing the last dollar. You choose the path; my job is to make sure you see all of them.

If I sell, *where do I go?*

It is the first question almost everyone asks, and the one that keeps most people from looking at a sale at all. It has a better answer than most people expect.

Where you go next is part of the plan, not something left until after. The closing date of a sale you run is set around your move, not the other way round. When a lender ends up selling instead, the date you have to leave is set by its timeline, and what you have in hand when you go is whatever is left after its costs.

If your credit has taken a hit, renting is usually the next step, and it is more within reach than it feels. Landlords look at more than a credit score. They look at income, references, and whether an application is complete and credible. A sale that pays out the mortgage, with money from it in hand, changes how that application reads.

What I help with

- **Finding the next place.** Rentals that fit your budget and your area, timed to your closing date.
- **A complete, credible application.** ID, proof of income, an employment letter, references, proof of funds, and a short, honest explanation where your credit needs one. Organised the way a landlord wants to see it.
- **No gap between the two.** The closing and the move-in lined up, so you are not choosing between a deadline and a place to live.

Why it belongs in the plan from day one

People who know where they are going make better decisions: a realistic price, a closing date that works, and no reason to wait until the choice is made for them. Waiting is the part that costs the most.

Approval is the landlord's decision, and nothing here guarantees one. A strong, complete application gives you the best chance.

Before you choose: *the one number all four depend on*

Every route in this guide turns on the same two figures. What the property is worth **today**, and what is actually owing against it.

Not what you paid for it. Not the assessment. Not what sold on the street two years ago. Values have moved, and a plan built on an old number is a plan built on nothing.

- Adding a suite or a second unit only makes sense measured against what the property is worth now.
- Releasing equity depends entirely on how much of it there actually is.
- And a sale only helps if what is left, after the mortgage and the costs of selling, is a number worth having.

Most people reading this are working from a figure that is two or three years old. That is usually the difference between a plan that holds and one that falls apart in the second week.

So start there

Send me the address and roughly what is owing. I will work out what it would realistically sell for today, and what you would be left with after the mortgage and the costs of selling, with the comparables I used so you can check the work. It takes about a day.

Then you can choose from the four routes knowing **which of them are actually open to you.**

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The bank sells it. *Or you do.*

Same house. The difference is who runs the sale, and who it is run for.

	LENDER-LED The lender sells it	OWNER-LED You sell it first
Who it is run for	The lender, to recover its loan	You. Your agent and your lawyer work for you
The price	Enough to cover the loan and its costs	Set by the market, from real recent sales
Costs off the top	The lender's legal and enforcement costs, its agent, then the mortgage	Commission and your lawyer, then the mortgage
How it is sold	As-is, with no seller disclosure. Buyers price in the unknowns	Prepared and presented properly, on terms you agree to
Your move date	Set by the lender's possession timeline	Set around your next place
If it falls short	The difference stays your debt	Raised with the lender before the sale, not after
What is left for you	Whatever remains after everyone else is paid, paid later	Paid to you at closing
On your record	A power of sale on title	An ordinary sale on title

Why the timing matters

It is open while you still control the timing. Each month behind adds to what is owed, and nothing to what the house is worth. The one number from the page before tells you which column you are working in today.

General information, not legal or financial advice. Every lender and every file is different, and nothing here guarantees an outcome. Any shortfall is a matter between you and your lender.

And if selling is the right move

When the numbers point to a sale, the strongest version of it is the one you run yourself: calm, well-run, and protecting as much of your equity as your timeline allows, on your terms, not a lender's clock. That is the work I do.

If you'd like to talk any of this through, I'm glad to help you find the path that fits.



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